ALL INDIA COUNCIL FOR TECHNICAL EDUCATION (AICTE)

Approval Process Handbook (APH) 2026-2027: Regulations & Norms

Statutory Regulatory Authority under Ministry of Education, Govt. of India

CHAPTER I: GENERAL POLICIES & APPROVAL FRAMEWORK

1.1 Statutory Mandate:
The All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE) is established by an Act of Parliament (Act 52 of 1987) to ensure proper planning and coordinated development of technical education throughout the country.

1.2 Scope of Approval:
Approval of AICTE is mandatory for establishing new technical institutions, introduction of new courses, increase in intake, extension of approval (EoA), and continuation of technical programmes including Engineering & Technology, Management, MCA, Pharmacy, Architecture, and Applied Arts & Crafts.

1.3 Key Governance & Digital Compliance:
All institutions must possess a permanent Unique AICTE Permanent ID (PID). Applications for Extension of Approval (EoA) and variation in intake must be submitted through the AICTE Centralized Web Portal along with digital verification dossiers, certified building plans, fire safety certificates, and university affiliation approvals.

CHAPTER II: GRANT OF APPROVAL FOR EXISTING INSTITUTIONS

Clause 2.1: Extension of Approval (EoA) Norms & Conditions

Clause 2.1.1 Eligibility for Extension of Approval (EoA):
Existing approved technical institutions seeking continuation of approval for the academic year 2026-2027 must satisfy standard regulatory norms without pending punitive action.

Clause 2.1.2 Mandatory Document Checklist for EoA:
Each institution must submit:
1. Valid Occupancy Certificate / Building Completion Certificate from the Competent Municipal Authority / Gram Panchayat / Town Planning Department.
2. Valid Fire Safety Certificate / NOC issued by the State Fire Services Department with annual validity.
3. Affiliation Order / Approval letter from the concerned Affiliating University / State Technical Board for the academic year.
4. Audited Financial Statements and Balance Sheet for the preceding financial year signed by a Certified Chartered Accountant.
5. Compliance affidavit confirming barrier-free environment for differently-abled persons, anti-ragging committee constitution, and internal complaint committee.

Clause 2.1.3 Land and Infrastructure Requirements:
Institutions must maintain clear, unencumbered land ownership or registered government lease (minimum 30 years):
- Mega and Metro Cities (e.g., Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad): Minimum 1.5 Acres contiguous land.
- Urban Areas (Corporation/Municipal limits): Minimum 2.5 Acres contiguous land.
- Rural Areas: Minimum 7.5 Acres contiguous land.
Total instructional and administrative built-up area must conform strictly to Appendix 4 of the APH.

CHAPTER II (Continued): VARIATION IN APPROVED INTAKE

Clause 2.5: Increase in Approved Student Intake Norms

Clause 2.5.1 Conditions for Expansion:
Institutions seeking an increase in student intake in existing undergraduate or postgraduate courses must fulfill the following mandatory pre-requisites:
1. Accreditation Status: Valid NBA accreditation in the specific programme or NAAC score of not less than 2.5 / A-Grade for the institution.
2. Cadre Ratio & Faculty Adequacy: The overall Student-to-Faculty Ratio (SFR) must strictly be 1:15 for Degree Engineering and 1:20 for Diploma/Management programmes. Cadre ratio of Professor : Associate Professor : Assistant Professor shall be maintained at 1:2:6.
3. Zero Deficiency History: No critical infrastructural or faculty deficiencies reported by the Scrutiny Committee or Expert Visit Committee (EVC) in the last two academic years.

Clause 2.5.2 Built-up Area and Laboratory Scaling:
For every additional division of 60 students:
- Minimum additional carpet area of 66 sq.m for classroom.
- Additional laboratory space of 66 sq.m with prescribed equipment per AICTE model curriculum.
- Additional 15 computer systems with licensed software and high-speed broadband connection (minimum 100 Mbps).
- Library expansion: Minimum 100 additional book titles and 500 volumes plus mandatory e-journal subscriptions.

CHAPTER II (Continued): DIVERSIFICATION AND NEW DISCIPLINES

Clause 2.7: Introduction of New Course / Programme Norms

Clause 2.7.1 Introduction of New Courses in Emerging Areas:
AICTE encourages introduction of programmes in Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Data Science, Cybersecurity, Internet of Things (IoT), Robotics, and Electric Vehicles.

Clause 2.7.2 Regulatory Approvals Required:
1. Board of Governors / Trust Resolution explicitly approving the introduction of the new programme.
2. Affiliating University No Objection Certificate (NOC) and syllabus endorsement.
3. Dedicated faculty recruitment plan with at least 1 Professor/Associate Professor with doctorate specialization in the emerging discipline.
4. Dedicated domain laboratories equipped before student admission commences.

Clause 2.7.3 Scrutiny and Verification:
All applications under Clause 2.7 are scrutinized by a National Scrutiny Committee with automated document verification followed by physical or virtual Expert Committee inspection.

CHAPTER V: SCRUTINY COMMITTEES & DOCUMENT INTEGRITY

Clause 5.1: Document Verification Standards for AICTE Scrutiny Officers

Clause 5.1.1 Officer Scrutiny Workflow:
Authorized Scrutiny Officers inspect uploaded dossiers against statutory criteria:
1. Verification of Authenticity: Verification seals, issuer authority designation, and issue dates must be clearly discernible without tampering.
2. Validity Windows: Fire NOC must be within its active 12-month or 3-year term. University affiliation must cover the impending academic year.
3. Land Records: Registered sale deeds, revenue khatoni/patta, and demarcation plans must show contiguous parcel coordinates.
4. Non-Compliance and Deficiencies: If a document fails scrutiny, the Officer records specific regulatory observations and triggers a 'Clarification Requested' action, granting the institution 7 working days to upload a replacement version.
5. Final Approval / Rejection: Orders are digitally certified and archived in the institutional DocuPass vault with an immutable audit trail.